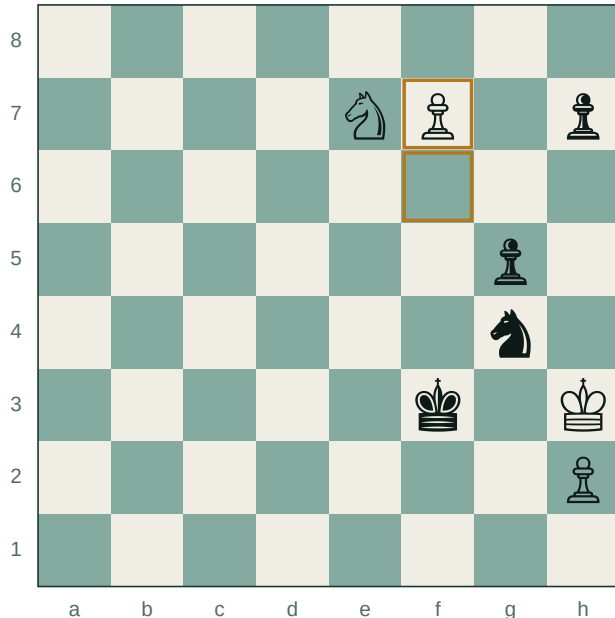


# Knight-ending routes: Black, move 51

Knight-ending routes

Black to move



Previous move: 51.f7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**51...Nf2#**

**51...Nf2#** Mate: knight on f2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on f2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Knight endings reward exact route calculation. Forks can change a pawn race, while a distant passer may outrun the knight's short-range movement.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on h3. Geometrically undefended: knight on e7. Check for tactical protection.